

# EEF Meeting Minutes, Thursday June 20, 2024

Erlang Ecosystem Foundation, Minutes of a Regular Meeting of the Board of Directors  
Meeting #101, June 20, 2024

A regular meeting of the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation was held over group conference call (Zoom). The meeting began at 16:07 UTC.

---

## Attendance

The following members of the board of directors were present (9/11): Francesco Cesarini, Maxim Fedorov, Amos King, Ben Marx, Bryan Paxton, Miriam Pena Villanueva, Peer Stritzinger, Sebastian Strollo, and Alistair Woodman.

The following members of the board of directors were absent: Kiko Fernandez-Reyes, Kenneth Lundin

Also present was Paula Calgaro from the marketing team

---

## Agenda Items

### 1. Approval of minutes from previous meetings.

*RESOLVED, that the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation approve the minutes as presented as representing a true and accurate record of the board meeting #99 held on May 9, 2024. Unanimously approved.*

*RESOLVED, that the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation approve the minutes as presented as representing a true and accurate record of the board meeting #100 held on June 6, 2024. Unanimously approved.*

### 2. Intermediate actions:

1. Alistair initiated application for a Microsoft Azure non-profit account - in progress
2. Alistair initiated OpenSSF membership, which would also mean that we would apply for associate membership in Linux Foundation (at the "associate" level - no financial cost / commitment)

3. Talks have been initiated regarding making an official fork of RIAK, possibly under the EEF name, or perhaps under its own name but supported by a working group under EEF.
3. Unanimous consent votes: none scheduled.
4. Membership report: Basic 1566 (+7 since last reported), Annual Supporting 136 (no change), Lifetime Supporting 22 (no change), Managing and Contributing 14 (no change). Financial report: Sebastian presented the current financials (bank balance of approximately \$140k, and balance including outstanding stipend payments at approximately \$60k).
5. Stipend request process update: Paula from the marketing team is joining to help with the stipend process. Peer is still working on the Trello integration.
6. Stipend requests
  1. "A CI/CD pipeline to robustly test hot code upgrades / downgrades for OTP releases" requested by Alexandre Zenon, for up to \$8000. Peer presented the proposal which would support Alexandre to complete the work he has done as a master thesis student. Comments from the board: "Would be good to get it working for Elixir as well", "Can it be made to work in other pipelines than Github?". Also the project need some community research to be viable. The proposal is to be conditioned on approval of the build and packaging working group.

*RESOLVED, that the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation approve the proposal from Alexandre Zenon for a budget not to exceed \$8,000 to proceed with the project laid out in the stipend request, conditioned on the approval of the Build and Packaging working group. Unanimously approved.*
  2. The training program stipend request from Matthew Spire (see last meeting) has been rejected by the education working group (in general the policy is to not grant stipends for personal training).
7. Any other business: none

8. Alistair declared the meeting adjourned at 16:59 UTC.

Dated June 20, 2024

Secretary of the meeting: \_\_\_\_\_ Sebastian Strollo

Attachments:

Stipend proposal from Alexandre Zenon (2 pages)

# Stipend Proposal

**Stipend Type** : Development Work

**Name** : Alexandre Zenon

**Nick Name** : Alex

**Country** : Belgium

**Intended product of project:** A CI/CD pipeline to robustly test hot code upgrades / downgrades for OTP releases. This tool would take the form of either a GitHub template or a GitHub action (based on what the community prefers) that leverages the Common Test and Peer modules to perform the tests and some docker containers to run the previous and upgrade to the updated version of the release.

**Purpose** Erlang's hot code replacement, the ability to update code without downtime, is a powerful feature that can significantly enhance the availability and flexibility of applications. This capability, further refined by OTP releases, empowers developers to make changes on the fly, adapting to evolving requirements or addressing issues without interrupting service. However, the complexity and potential risks associated with testing these upgrades often lead to underutilization, leaving one of Erlang's key strengths unexploited. This project seeks to remove these barriers by providing an automated testing pipeline. Leveraging continuous integration (CI), it enables developers to validate upgrades after every commit, ensuring their correctness and compatibility with the existing system. This proactive approach eliminates the need for last-minute testing before release, saving time and resources while increasing confidence in the upgrade process. By ensuring the reliability of hot code upgrades and downgrades, developers gain the confidence to fully embrace this functionality. Knowing that their changes can be implemented seamlessly and without adverse effects empowers them to leverage this capability. This increased confidence can lead to a wider adoption of hot code upgrades across the Erlang community, democratizing this underutilized feature and transforming it into a standard practice.

**Development Plan** Prototype: A functional prototype, available as a GitHub template at <https://github.com/Ahzed11/HotCI>, serves as the foundation for further development. Evaluation: Gather comprehensive feedback from users and the wider Erlang community to assess the prototype's strengths, weaknesses, and potential improvements. Refinement: Based on the evaluation results, determine which components of the template to retain and decide on the final form the tool should take, considering user preferences and community needs. Redevelopment: Redesign and

rebuild the tool in the format determined by the evaluation process, ensuring it aligns with user expectations and addresses identified issues. Problem Resolution: Prioritize and fix the problems highlighted in the evaluations, enhancing the tool's functionality, usability, and reliability. Feature Implementation: Incorporate requested features and enhancements to expand the tool's capabilities and better serve the Erlang community's diverse requirements.

**Dissemination** : Master Thesis Meetup events Louvain-la-Neuve (Possibly) Amsterdam  
Blog posts Social networks (LinkedIn, Reddit, Erlang Forums)

**Delivery Method** : Github repo

**Stipend Amount (USD)** : 8000